

DoorDash Professional Network

Independent Product Proposal

Author perspective: Active Gold Status Dasher with 4+ years of first-hand experience using the Dasher app and working with restaurant pickup workflows, delivery operations, and customer service.

Relationship notice: The author has a genuine service-provider relationship with DoorDash through the Dasher platform. This is not an official DoorDash, Inc. product and does not imply corporate sponsorship, endorsement, approval, or employment.

Executive Thesis

DoorDash already connects customers, merchants, and Dashers. This proposal adds a fourth layer: **professional development and economic mobility**. Structured merchant observations become optional professional evidence, while Dashers gain control of profiles containing transferable skills, education, career interests, and recognition metrics.

Founder Insight

Four-plus years of direct Dasher experience reveals a recurring gap: Dashers demonstrate reliability, communication, customer service, time management, problem solving, navigation, merchant relations, and independent work discipline, yet much of that performance is difficult to translate into portable career evidence.

1. Workforce Opportunity

The U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics reports approximately **1.53 million** delivery truck driver and driver/sales-worker jobs in 2024 and projects about **171,400 openings per year** over 2024-2034. Overall employment is projected to grow **8%**.

Pew Research Center found that **94%** of U.S. adults viewed gig-platform work as a good way to earn extra money and **94%** as a good way to work flexibly, but only **31%** viewed it as a good way to build a career.

Opportunity: Delivery platforms coordinate a large professional network, but workers inside that network have limited infrastructure for portable reputation, transferable-skill evidence, professional recognition, and career mobility.

2. Product Experience

Merchant Quality Loop

Six concise questions about observable pickup behavior: presentation, respect, insulated-bag use where applicable, instruction adherence, order care, and interaction efficiency.

Dasher Professional Profile

Voluntary professional headline, biography, skills, education, career interests, goals, and aggregate recognition metrics.

Get to Know Your Dasher

Optional customer-facing professional card containing only Dasher-approved information. Private contact information stays hidden by default.

Trust and Aggregation Layer

Minimum sample sizes, anomaly detection, dispute mechanisms, data minimization, and separation of subjective observations from verified credentials.

Career Opportunity Layer

Potential pathways to training, merchant opportunities, networking, internal opportunities, and external career mobility.

3. Merchant Feedback

A participating restaurant manager could answer:

- Was the Dasher well presented? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**
- Was the Dasher respectful to restaurant staff? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**
- Was an appropriate insulated delivery bag used? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**
- Were pickup instructions followed? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**
- Was the order handled carefully? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**
- Was the interaction efficient? **YES / NO / NOT OBSERVED**

Positive recognition can include Professional, Prepared, Efficient, Helpful, Reliable, and Excellent Communication.

Design principle: This should not become a one-interaction punishment engine.

Negative observations require safeguards and aggregation; positive recognition creates a constructive professional-development loop.

4. Professional Profile

Professional evidence	Illustrative display
Rated pickups	427
Respectful interactions	98%
Professional presentation	97%
Instruction adherence	96%
Skills	Customer Service, Logistics, Technology
Career interests	Operations, Technical Support, Software Development

All non-platform profile fields should be Dasher-controlled. The system should not expose private telephone numbers, personal email addresses, home addresses, or unnecessary personal data.

5. Hypothetical McDonald's Pilot

McDonald's is used solely as a hypothetical high-volume case study. No participation, endorsement, approval, or sponsorship is claimed.

Dimension	Proposal
Locations	50 restaurants
Duration	8 weeks
Workflow	Structured post-pickup feedback
Dasher participation	Voluntary profiles
Manager access	Merchant application / mobile workflow
Evaluation	Baseline vs. pilot comparison

Primary measures

- pickup dwell time
- merchant feedback completion
- complaint and block rates
- handling incidents
- positive recognition
- profile activation
- career-interest engagement
- merchant satisfaction
- Dasher retention

6. Technical Architecture

**Order / Pickup Event -> Merchant Feedback Service -> Trust & Aggregation Layer
-> Dasher Professional Profile -> Customer Card / Career Opportunity Layer**

The prototype uses Flask and SQLite. Production integration could extend merchant applications, manager mobile workflows, and Point of Sale systems. POS means **Point of Sale**.

7. Privacy, Fairness, and Trust

- Profiles are voluntary and Dasher-controlled.
- Feedback focuses on observable pickup behavior.
- Protected characteristics are never requested.
- Minimum sample sizes apply before aggregate ratings appear.
- Dashers receive dispute and correction mechanisms.
- Abuse detection identifies coordinated or anomalous ratings.
- Manager notes are access-controlled and retention-limited.
- Verified credentials remain distinct from subjective observations.

The objective is professional recognition and development, not surveillance.

8. Business Case and Recommendation

DoorDash already possesses the network relationships necessary to make this concept powerful: merchants observe pickup behavior, Dashers perform the work, and customers experience the final service. A professional-development layer can convert those repeated interactions into structured evidence.

Recommendation

Evaluate the concept as a limited opt-in pilot rather than a platform-wide rating change. Test whether structured positive recognition and voluntary professional profiles improve merchant experience and create meaningful career-development engagement without increasing punitive feedback or privacy risk.

Every delivery already produces evidence of work. The opportunity is to let Dashers, with safeguards and consent, turn that work into professional capital.

Sources

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Delivery Truck Drivers and Driver/Sales Workers, Occupational Outlook Handbook.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/delivery-truck-drivers-and-driver-sales-workers.htm>

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<https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2021/12/08/americans-experiences-earning-money-through-online-gig-platforms/>

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